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🔑 Command Terms at a Glance

Find the command term ➔ look at the picture ➔ know what to do

⚡ Short answers | 🔢 Calculations | ✏️ Drawing and graphs | 🗂️ Organizing information | 💡 Describing and explaining | ⚖️ Thinking and judging

short answer ⟶ deep thinking

⚡ Short answers – Just give the answer. No explanation needed.



Define
Exact meaning of a word



Identify
Pick it or name it



List
Several short answers



Measure
Use a tool to get a value



Recall
Remember what you learned



Select
Choose from a list



State
A short fact, no reason



Write down
Copy the answer from the info

🔢 Calculations – Use numbers. Show your working.



Calculate
Work it out, show steps



Determine
Find the only answer

Estimate
A sensible guess with numbers



Find
Get the answer, show working



Show
Every step, written out



Solve
Use the right method



Verify
Prove the answer is right

✏️ Drawing and graphs – Show it as a picture, diagram or graph.



Annotate
Add notes to a picture



Construct
Build a diagram or structure



Draw
Accurate, ruler, labels



Label
Name the parts



Plot
Mark points on a graph



Sketch
Quick shape, key features

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🗂️ Organizing information – Sort, arrange or give the main points.



Classify
Sort into groups



Document
Credit your sources



Organize
Put in a clear order



Present
Show it clearly



Summarize
Main points only

💡 Describing and explaining – Write more. Give details and reasons.



Outline
Brief main points



Describe
Detailed picture in words



Explain
What happens + WHY



Interpret
Find the pattern, conclude



Demonstrate
Prove it with evidence



Formulate
Say it clearly, precisely

⚖️ Thinking and judging – Think deeply. Use evidence. Make a decision.



Analyse
Break it down



Apply
Use it in a new situation



Comment
Give your judgement



Design
Make a plan



Discuss
Both sides, then decide



Evaluate
Strengths vs weaknesses



Justify
Back it up with reasons



Suggest
Propose an idea

💬 State vs 🖼️ Describe vs 💡 Explain
State = the fact.
Describe = what happens, in detail.
Explain = what happens + **why**.

💡 Explain vs 🛡️ Justify
Explain = give the reasons **how/why** something happens.
Justify = give reasons that **support your answer** or choice.

🗣️ Discuss vs ⚖️ Evaluate
Discuss = both sides, then a conclusion.
Evaluate = strengths + weaknesses, then a judgement.

📐 Draw vs 〰️ Sketch
Draw = accurate, ruler, scale, labels.
Sketch = quick, general shape, key features labelled.

🧮 Calculate vs ≈ Estimate
Calculate = exact number, show steps.
Estimate = sensible approximate value.

✅ Before you hand in
Did I underline the command term?
Did I write the right amount?
Did I include units?

Based on the IB MYP command terms for sciences. Simplified for students.